Lesson 4

Cultivating Mindfulness

The Science of Positivity, Mindfulness & Wellbeing

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The lesson content is developed by Gözde Tutanç. The researches / articles and other materials used are listed with their sources.

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“You can't stop the waves, **but you can learn to surf**”

- Jon Kabat-Zinn

Essential Elements of Mindfulness

Intention

The intention to notice what is in the moment, to return to the moment



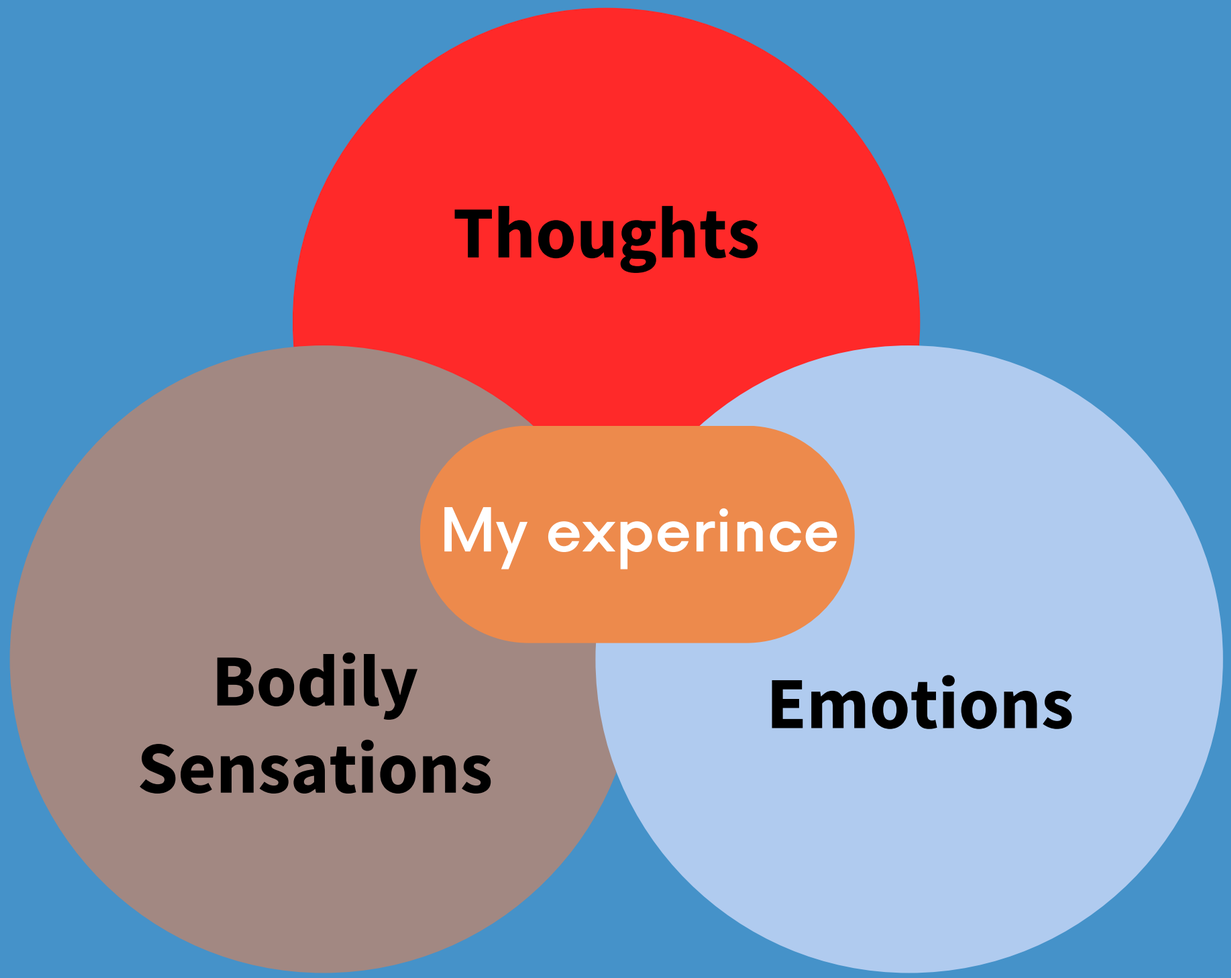
Attention

A gentle attention to the inner and outer experience in the present moment: Bodily sensations, emotions, thoughts

Attitude

Attention accompanied by certain attitudes: With curiosity, openness, beginner's mind, without judgment, friendly, gently

My Experience (3D)



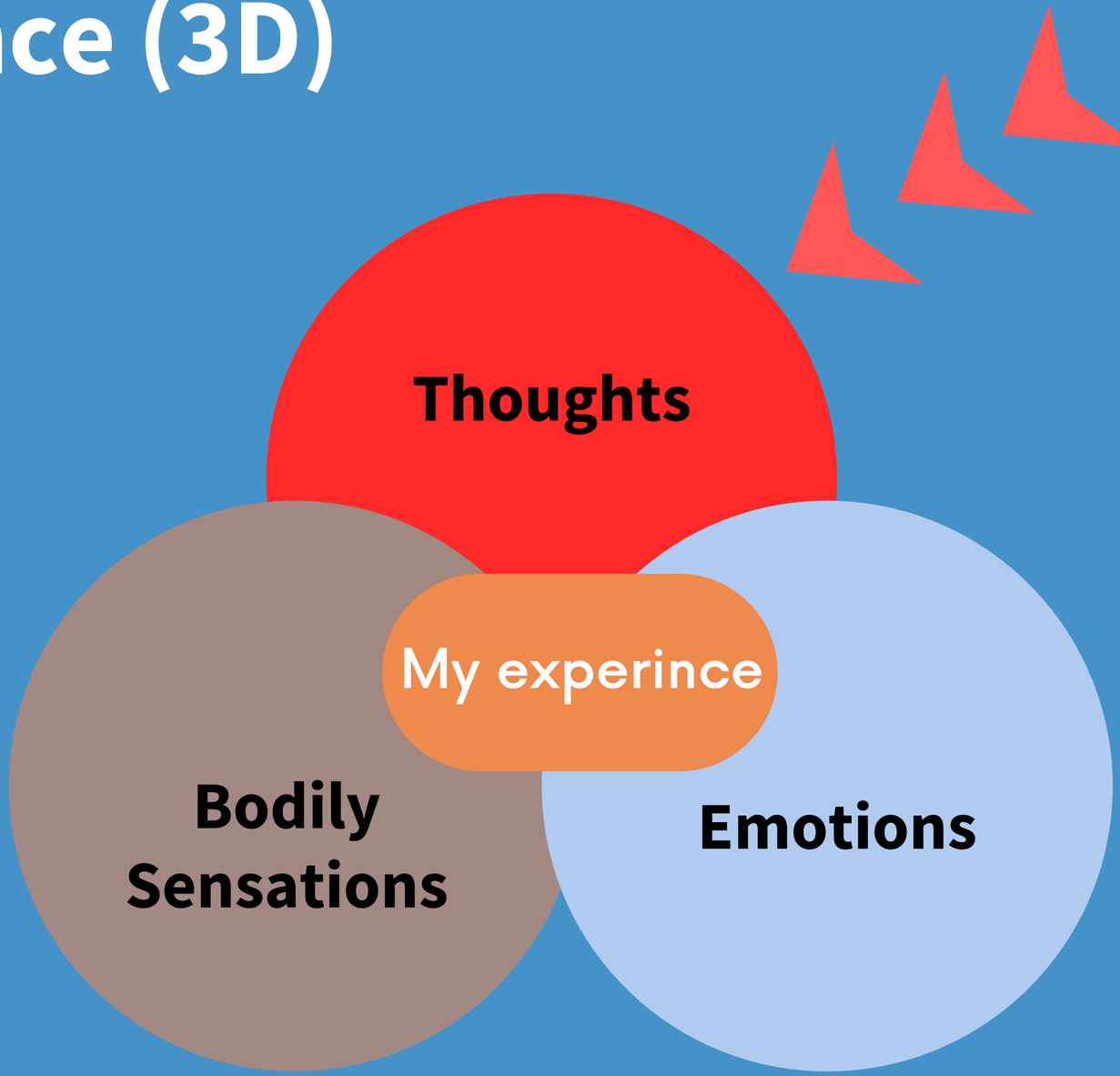
In summary..

- Mindfulness is conscious and intentional.
- **Mindfulness is awareness with a certain attitude**. It is approaching each moment without judgement, with open curiosity and acceptance.
- Mindfulness includes the whole of experience: **sensations, thoughts, feelings, emotions that occur inside and outside of us.**
- **Mindfulness is a friendly awareness of the self.**



Mindfulness = Heartfulness

My Experience (3D)





“With **our thoughts, we create the world**”

- Buddha



How we perceive challenges also determines our attitude towards them.

What happened in the past conditions our habits and beliefs.

The mind takes sides, the mind writes stories!

A	+	B	=	C
Situation		**Interpretation**		**Response**
The Truth Objective Sensory		Imaginary Subjective Mental		Sensation Reflection Emotion Behaviour
Primary Experience		Secondary Experience		

Mood
Judgements
Conditioning
Mental moulds
Stories

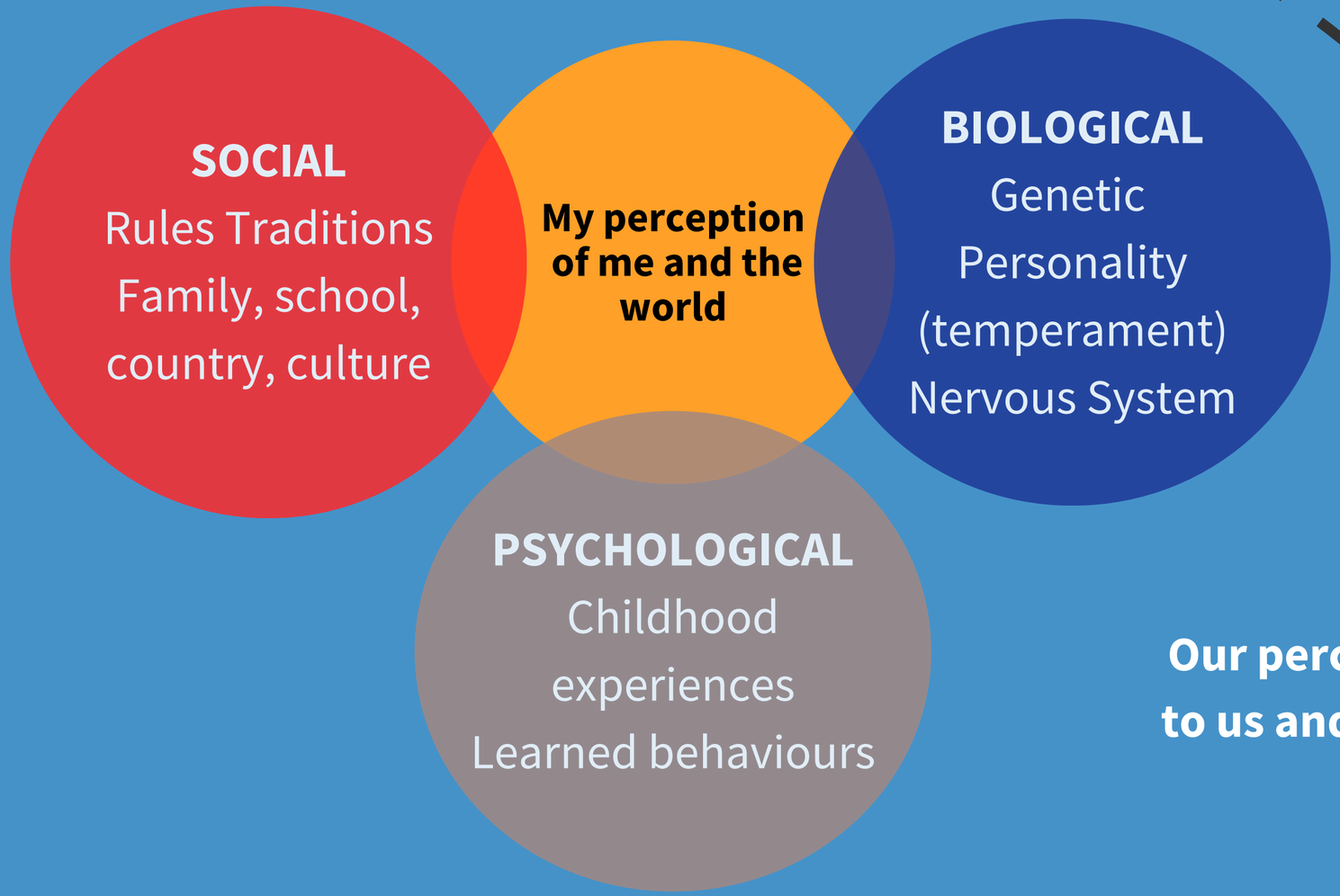


“**10%** of life is made up of what happens to you.

90% of life is decided by how you react.”

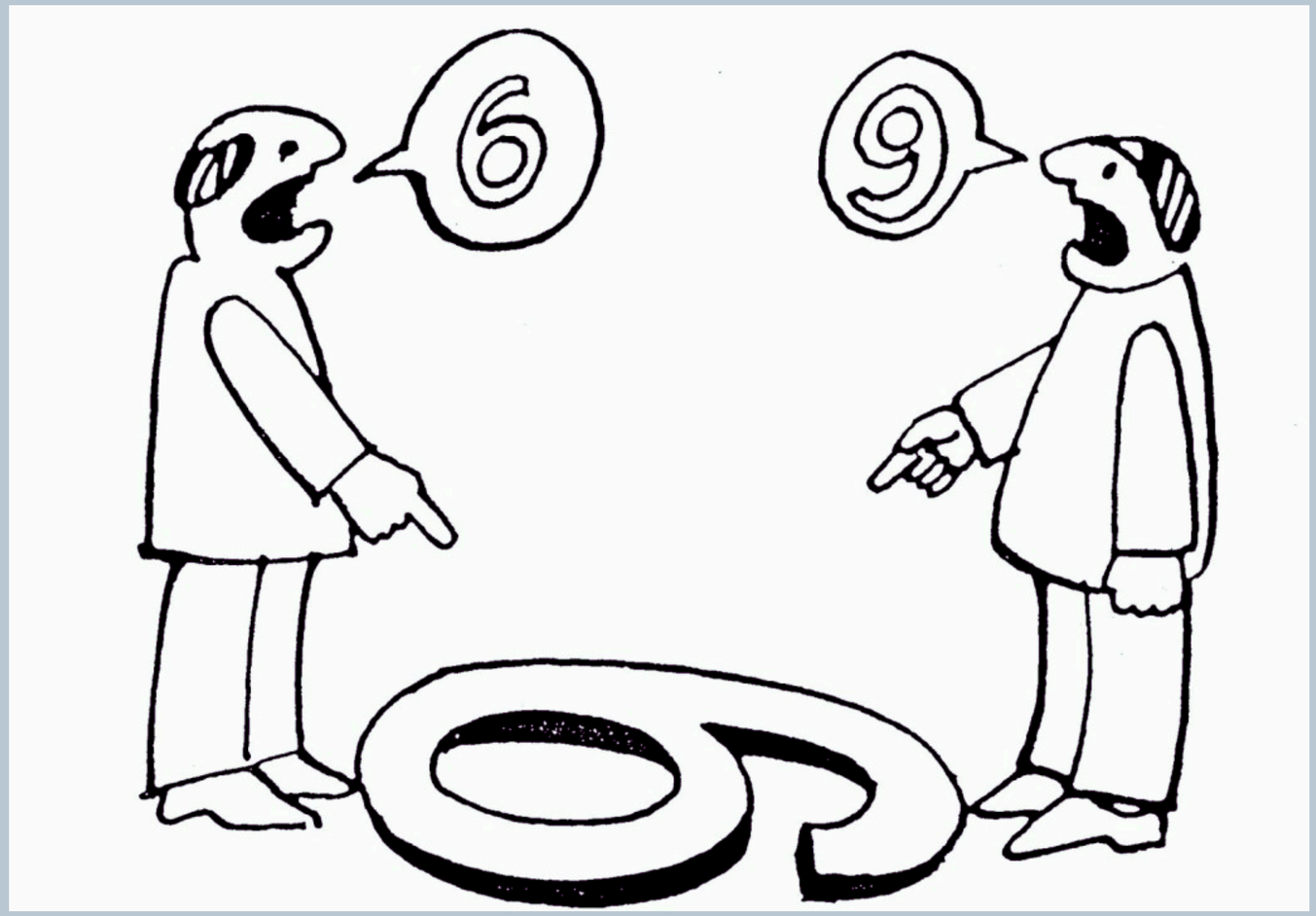
-Stephen Covey

Perception

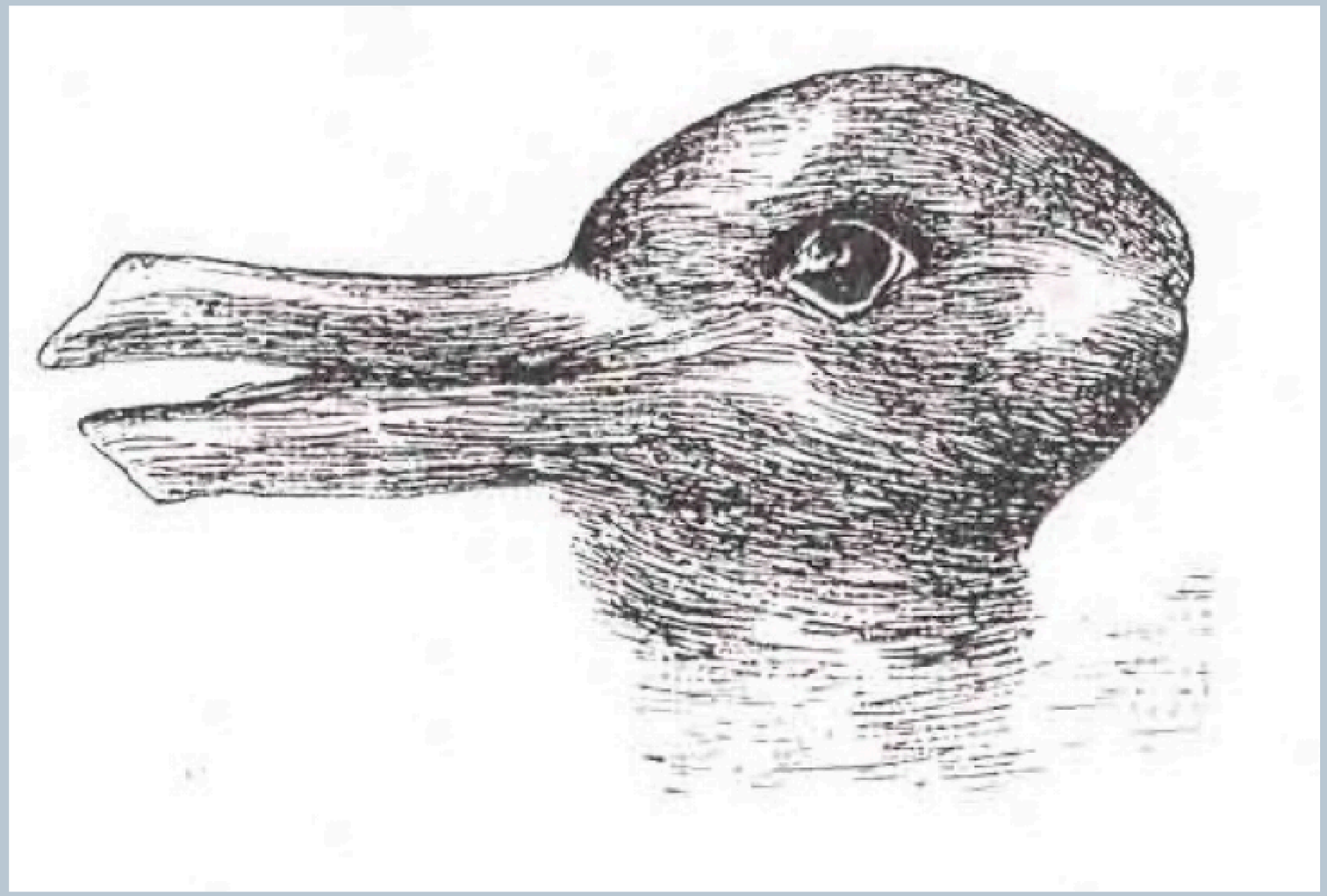


Our perceptions are unique to us and constantly change

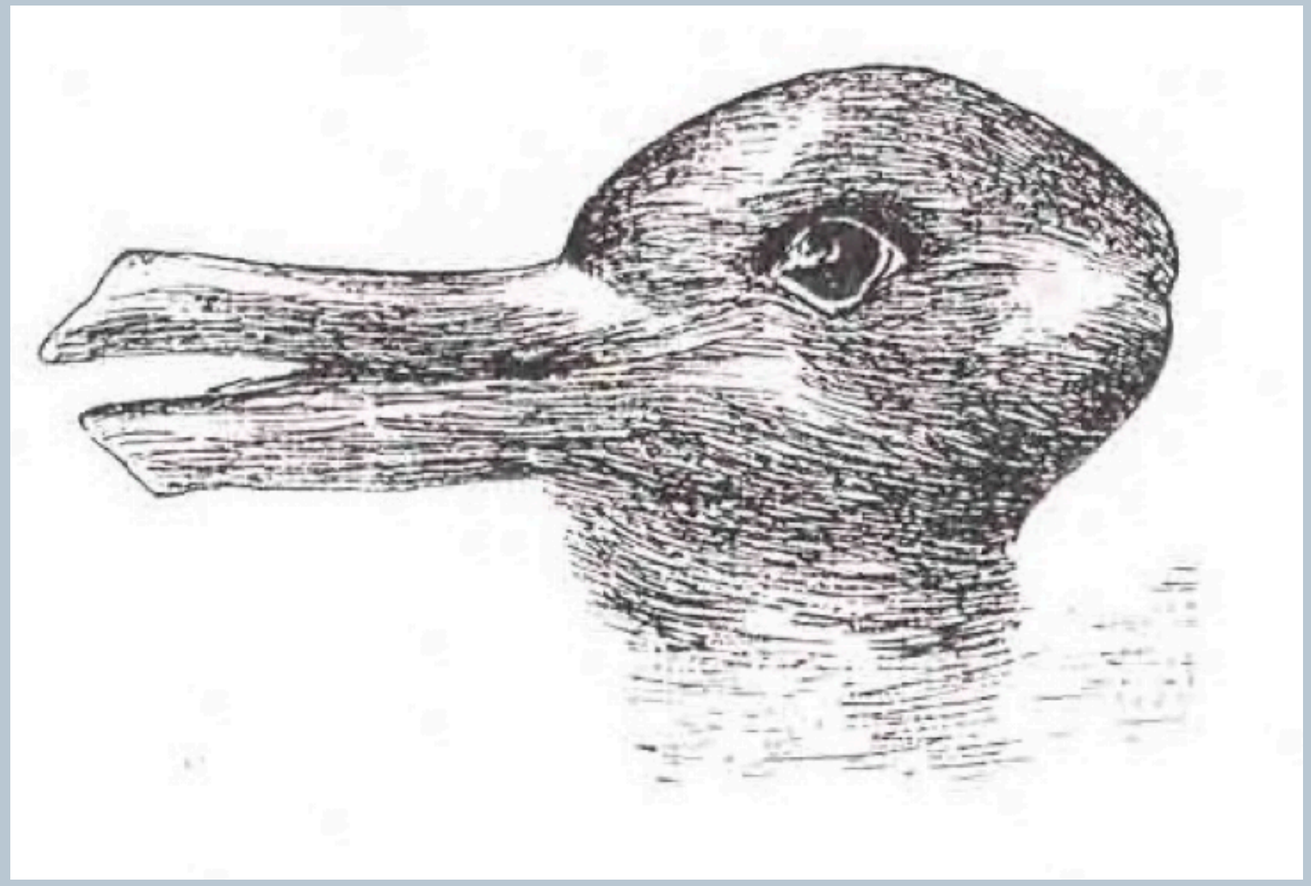
This is why no two people who experience the same thing feel the same

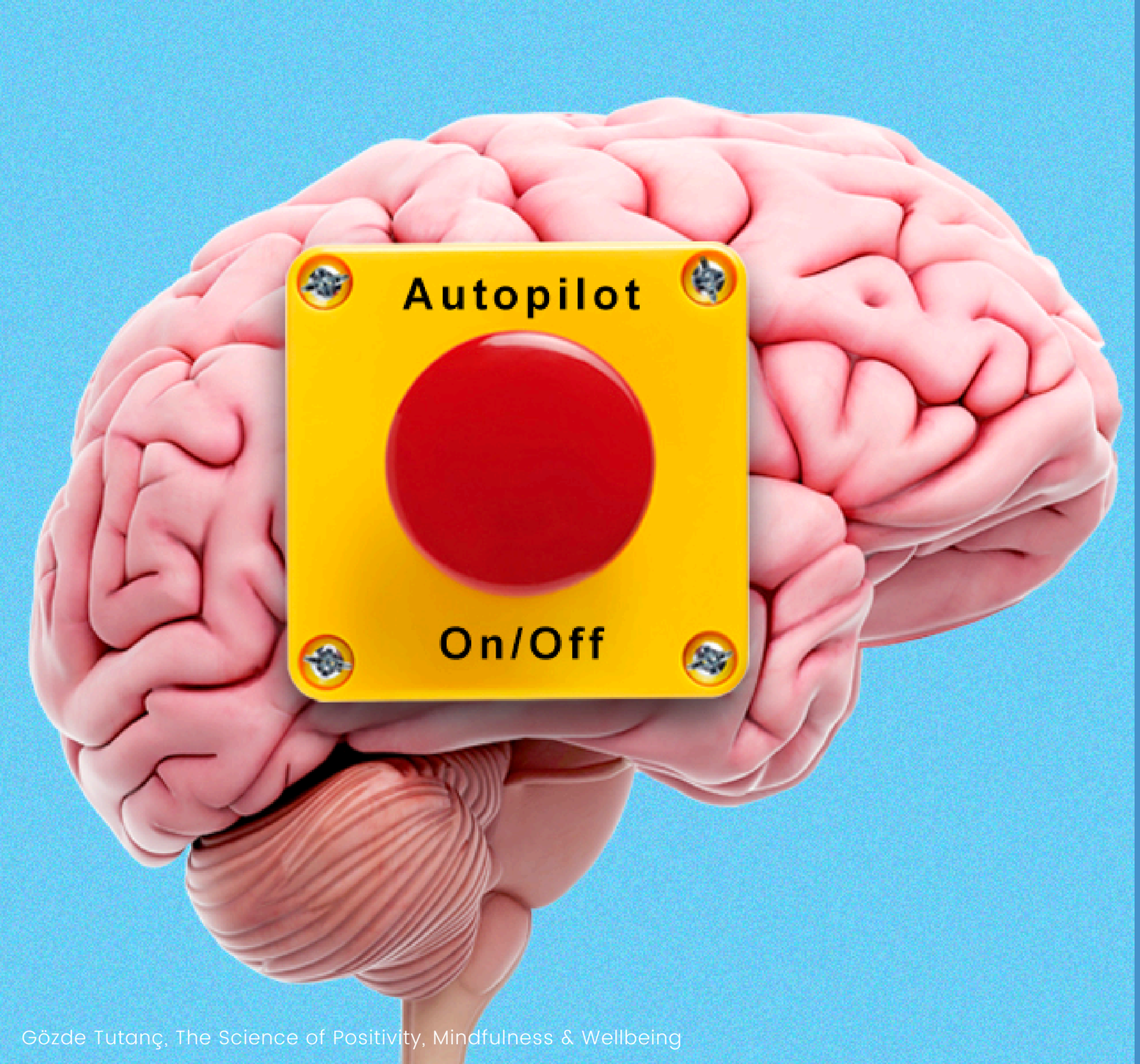


Optical Illusion



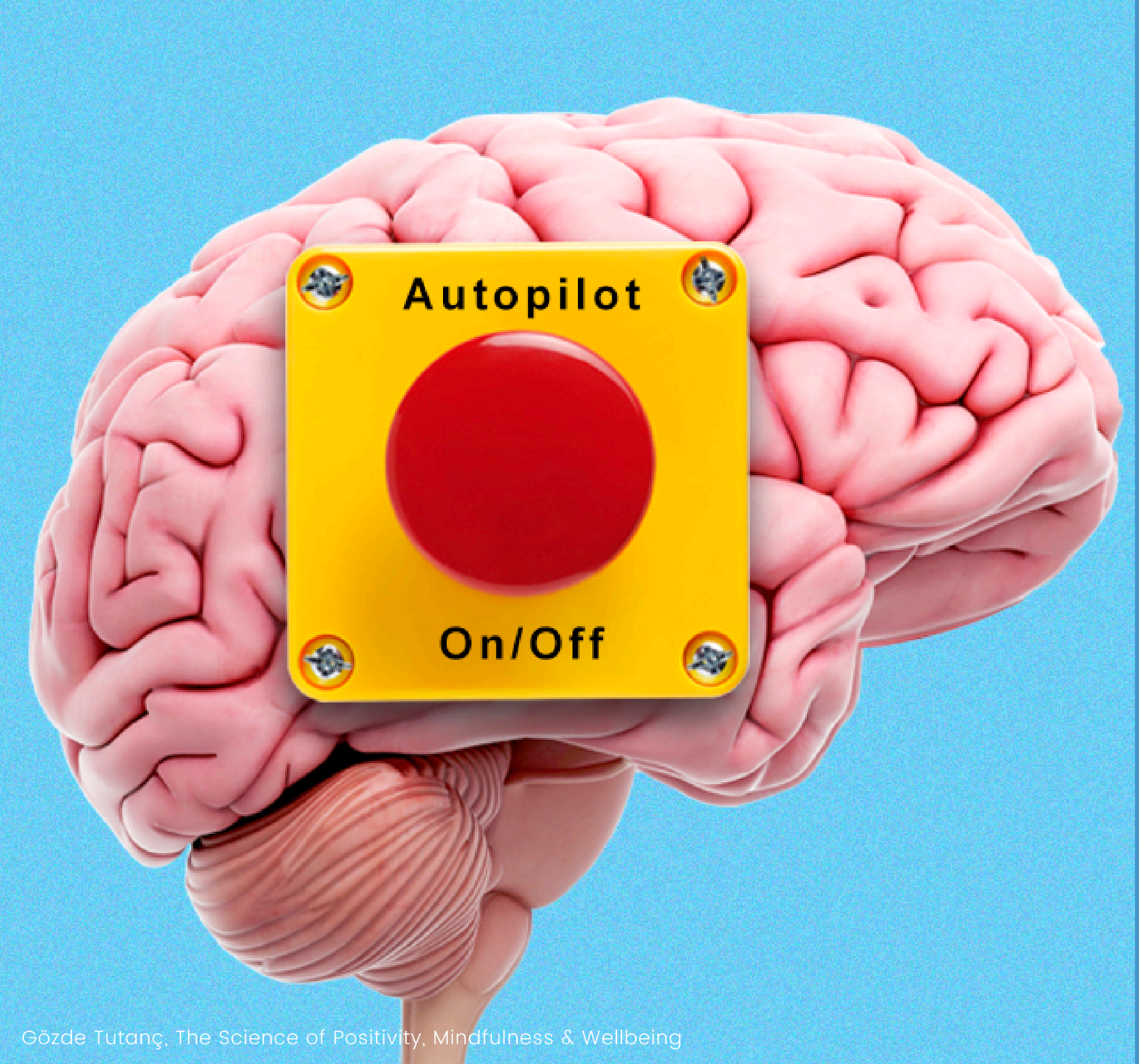
What makes the difference in the same living conditions is how each person perceives the situation.





Seeing events with our habitual patterns also causes us to react habitually, that is, to give our automatic reactions.

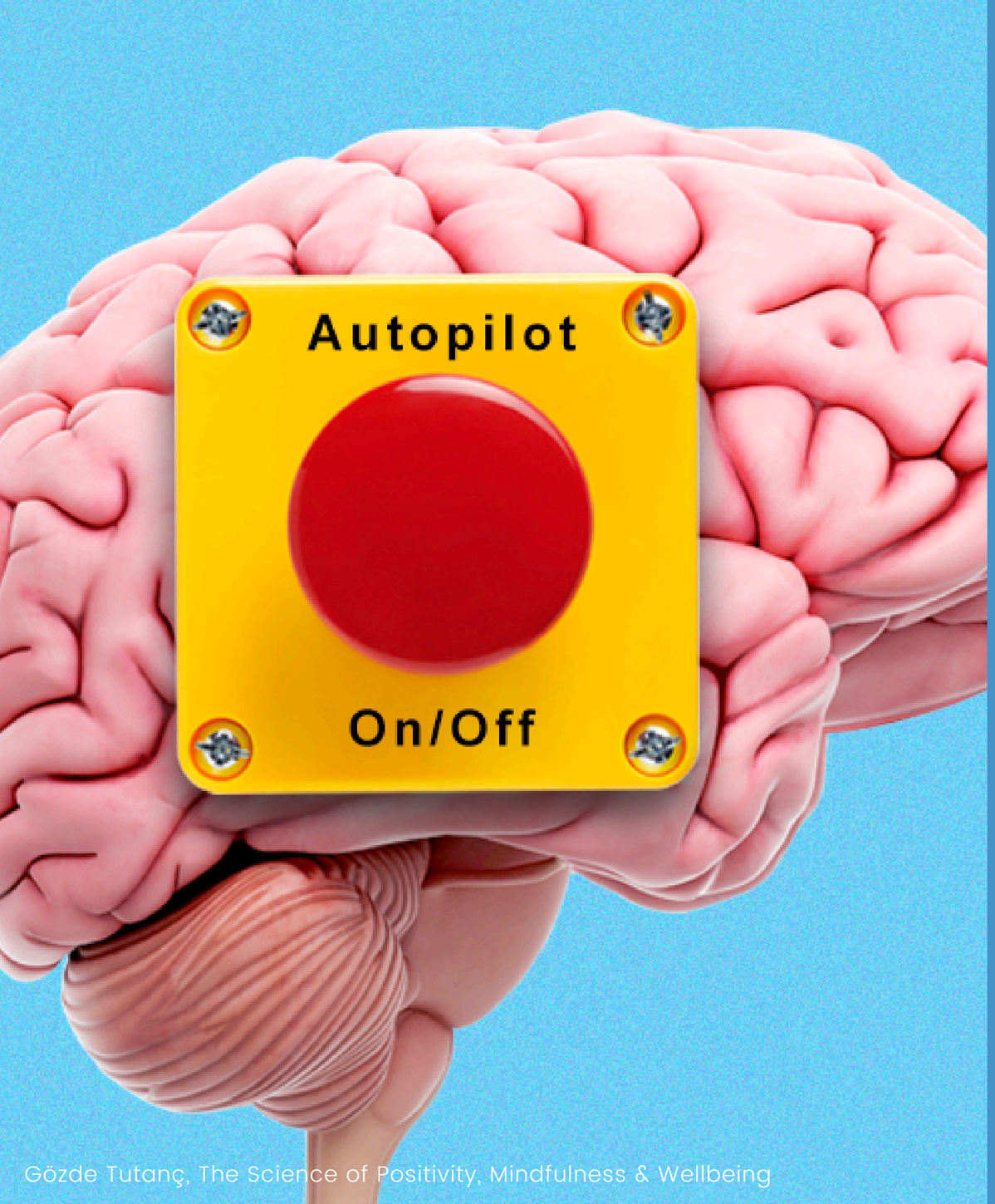
These reactions are our Autopilot reactions triggered from the ‘Default Mode Network’.



The Autopilot

The dominant state of unawareness of the mind is autopilot.

- Forgetting the name of the person you met immediately
- When you enter the kitchen, you forget why you entered
- Eating when you are not hungry
- When you are having a conversation with your friend and you realise that they are asking you something, but you have no idea what they are talking about.



The Autopilot

Our reactions, especially to stressful situations, are often automatic and blind.

- Autopilot + Stress = **More Stress**
- Autopilot + Worry = **More Worry**
- Autopilot + Feeling Bad = **More Feeling Bad**



‘What is important in determining whether the person is feeling stress and whether they are getting sick, **it is not the stress trigger**, **but how the individual interprets and copes with it**’

-Martin Seligman

Foundational Mindfulness Attitudes

Non-Judging

Patience

Acceptance

Beginners Mind

Trust

Letting Go

Non-Striving

Gratitude

Generosity

Self-compassion & Kindness

Playfulness & Humour